Daily Economic Briefing

Thursday 5 November 2026 | Window: Tue 3 Nov 2026 20:00 ET – Wed 4 Nov 2026 20:21 ET (Wed 4 Nov close/AH, the window's one NYSE session) | Research cutoff Wed 4 Nov 2026 20:21 ET | Edition 57

60-second read

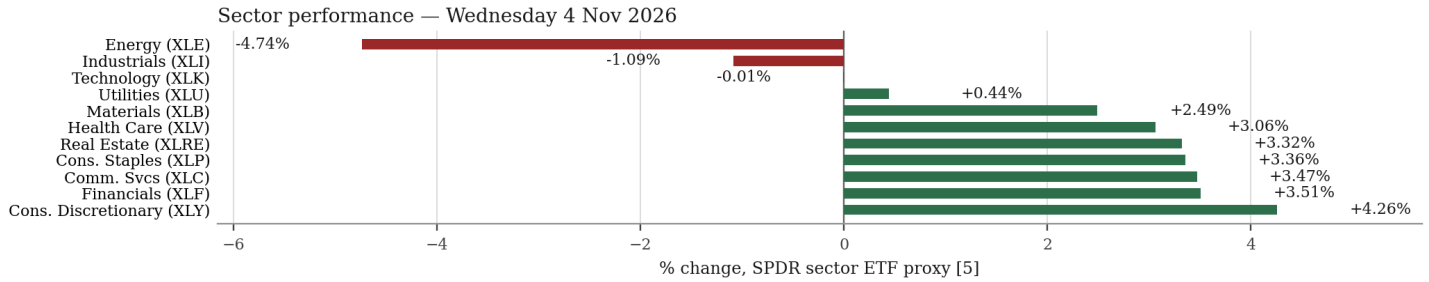
1. **Democrats swept both the House and Senate** in Tuesday's midterms, ending unified Republican control of Washington; VP Vance blamed the rout on "the war" with Iran.[1][2] Equities rallied hard (Dow +3.03%, S&P +1.58%), oil crashed more than 8% and the VIX posted its sharpest one-day collapse on record in this report, all on a fading war-risk premium.[3]
2. Earnings were a mixed, name-specific story layered on top of the macro rally: **Amdocs -30.1%** on a shock FY27 guidance cut tied to a T-Mobile contract dispute, and **Qualcomm -7.5% after hours** on a miss versus a $2.36 consensus — while **Cricut (+48.7%), Kyndryl (+30.1%), Duolingo (+26.0%), Helen of Troy (+25.4%)** and Uber (+4.9%) all surged on beats or M&A news.[6][7]
3. Sweden's Riksbank delivered a surprise 25bp hike to 2.00%, its first increase since 2023; December FOMC hike odds firmed further to approximately 77-80% and the RBA's own next decision was confirmed for 7-8 December, resolving a standing open thread.[14][16][18]
4. Nine of 11 S&P sector ETFs closed higher in a broad, rate-sensitive rotation (Discretionary, Financials and Communication Services led); Energy (-4.74%) was the lone casualty of the oil crash and Technology was flat.[5]
5. Ahead: the Bank of England decides Thursday, the October jobs report and the next CFTC positioning report both land Friday, and a Section 301 tariff-exclusion window for 178 Chinese products lapses Monday 9 November absent a fresh extension.[21][22]

1. Market recap

S&P 500	Dow Jones	Nasdaq Comp.	Russell 2000	VIX	10-Yr Treasury
7,688.62	**53,356.12**	**25,736.51**	**2,856.95**	**16.61**	**4.90%**
+1.58%	+3.03%	+1.44%	+1.58%	-20.26%	-5bp

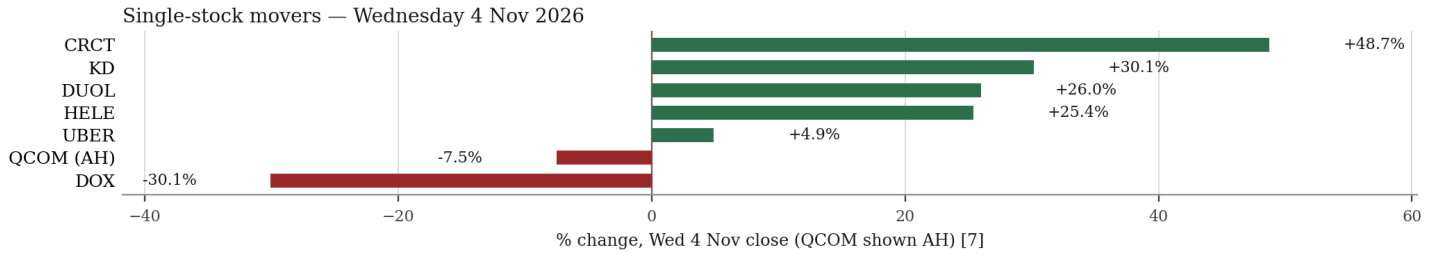
U.S. equities surged Wednesday after Tuesday's midterm elections handed Democrats control of both the House and Senate — a result CNBC and PBS NewsHour both called by Wednesday morning, with Democrats flipping at least seven Senate seats (Iowa, Kansas, Ohio, North Carolina, New Hampshire, South Carolina and Texas, the last ending Ken Paxton's bid for the seat) to retake the chamber outright.[1][2] Vice President Vance, in a Wednesday social-media post, blamed the result squarely on "the war" with Iran, adding "the president himself said so last night."[1] AP's own wire coverage (via its La Nación and WTOP syndication mirrors) attributed the rally directly to "the president's party los[ing] its unified control of Washington."[3] The S&P 500 rose 1.58% to 7,688.62, the Dow jumped 3.03% to 53,356.12 — the largest one-day move logged in this report's history — the Nasdaq Composite added 1.44% to 25,736.51 and the Russell 2000 gained 1.58% to 2,856.95.[3] An ETF-proxy cross-check (SPY +1.65%, DIA +3.10%, QQQ +0.97%, IWM +1.51%) corroborated both direction and rough magnitude.[4] Markets read the result, together with fading odds of further Mideast escalation, as easing the war-risk premium embedded in oil and volatility: WTI fell 8.3% and Brent fell 8.67% (Section 4), while the VIX posted its sharpest one-day decline on record in this report (Section 5).

Sector performance



Nine of 11 SPDR sector ETFs closed higher, a near-complete reversal of Tuesday's narrow, Tech-led pattern. Consumer Discretionary (XLY, +4.26%) led, followed by Financials (XLF, +3.51%), Communication Services (XLC, +3.47%), Consumer Staples (XLP, +3.36%) and Real Estate (XLRE, +3.32%) — a broad, rate-sensitive rally consistent with Wednesday's 3-5bp decline across the Treasury curve (Section 4). Materials (+2.49%) and Utilities (+0.44%) also closed higher. Technology (XLK) was essentially flat (-0.01%), a sharp deceleration from Tuesday's +1.31% AI-driven gain. Energy (XLE, -4.74%) was the session's lone outright casualty, tracking crude's post-election collapse, and Industrials (XLI, -1.09%) also slipped — the two sectors with the most direct commodity/war-premium exposure.[5]

2. Equities and earnings



Ticker	Move	Driver

Cricut (CRCT)	+48.74%	Q3 beat, revenue +11% y/y to $188.6m; announced a $0.70 special dividend plus a new $0.10 recurring semi-annual dividend[7][10]
Kyndryl (KD)	+30.14%	Q2 FY27 beat, adjusted EPS $0.42 vs. $0.38 y/y; hyperscaler-related revenue +27.2%; FY27 guidance reaffirmed[7][11]
Duolingo (DUOL)	+25.99%	Q3 beat, revenue $309.0m (+14% y/y) above the company's own guide; DAUs 64.9m (+29%)[7][9]
Helen of Troy (HELE)	+25.39%	Board rejected an unsolicited $37.00/share all-cash buyout from Empower Brands (Spectrum Brands/Oaktree); shares closed almost exactly at the rejected bid price[7][13]
Uber (UBER)	+4.91%	Q3 beat, Gross Bookings $59.8bn (+20% constant-currency); non-GAAP EPS $0.88, the top of its guided range[7][8]
Qualcomm (QCOM)	+5.33% regular / -7.52% AH	Broad election rally lifted the regular close ahead of the print; FQ4 non-GAAP EPS $2.17 missed a $2.36 (LSEG) consensus and the Q1 FY27 guide landed below prior Street estimates, driving the after-hours reversal[6][7]
Amdocs (DOX)	-30.07%	FY27 guidance shock (revenue growth guided -17.9% to -14.3% as reported) tied to an active T-Mobile contract dispute and USCellular-integration wind-down; an 8-year AT&T "agentic operating system" deal and an approx. $340m EIS insurance-software acquisition disclosed as partial offsets[7][12]

Qualcomm's FQ4 results themselves were not a disaster in isolation — GAAP EPS $1.17 and non-GAAP EPS $2.17, both down y/y against a tough prior-year comparison — but missed the higher end of Street expectations cited by Reuters/LSEG ($2.36) by enough to drive a clean after-hours reversal even as the broader tape rallied; the AH print above (-7.52% to $160.16) is a late-session snapshot rather than a confirmed final settle.[6][7] Amdocs' guidance cut is the session's largest single-name move and is genuinely company-specific: it is a foreign private issuer that reports via Form 6-K rather than 8-K, which is why at least one earnings-calendar aggregator had the date wrong (listing 10 November) before the actual 3-4 November release was confirmed directly against the filing.[12] A separate aggregator error was caught and corrected before publication: Kyndryl's report was listed by one calendar source as due 6 November but had in fact already been filed 4 November, confirmed via its own 8-K.[11] No analyst upgrade, downgrade or price-target action dated specifically to Wednesday's session could be verified via available sources — see Annex B.

3. Macro, policy and rates

Central bank	Policy rate	Last change	Next decision
Federal Reserve	3.75%-4.00%	Held, 28 Oct 2026 (10-2, hawkish dissent)	8-9 Dec 2026
Bank of Japan	approx. 1.25%	Held, 29-30 Oct 2026 (8-1)	17-18 Dec 2026
Bank of England	3.75%	Held, 17 Sept 2026 (6-3)	5 Nov 2026 (Thu)
European Central Bank	Deposit 2.50% / refi 2.65% / lending 2.90%	Held, 28-29 Oct 2026	Unconfirmed; est. mid-Dec by cadence
Bank of Canada	2.50%	Hiked 25bp, 28 Oct 2026	9 Dec 2026
Reserve Bank of Australia	4.85%	Hiked 25bp, 3 Nov 2026 (6-3, first split vote this cycle)	7-8 Dec 2026[16]
Swiss National Bank	0.00%	Held, 24 Sept 2026	10 Dec 2026
Norges Bank	4.50%	Hiked 25bp, 24 Sept 2026	17 Dec 2026
Riksbank	2.00%	Hiked 25bp, 4 Nov 2026 (first hike since 2023)[14]	16 Dec 2026[14]
Banxico	6.50% (secondary-sourced)	Held, 24 Sept 2026	5 Nov 2026 (Thu, secondary-sourced)[17]

The Riksbank delivered the session's other major surprise: a 25bp hike to 2.00% effective 11 November, its first increase since 2023, citing "stronger economic activity combined with cost increases due to supply disruptions" pushing inflation above target next year and signalling "it is likely that the policy rate will be raised further" if the outlook holds.[14] The vote split was not stated in the release; minutes follow 10 November.[14] October's ISM Services PMI slipped to 54.5, below the 54.8 consensus and September's 54.9 — a third straight month without acceleration; sub-index detail (prices paid, new orders) could not be verified this edition.[15] The RBA's next decision was confirmed directly against its own published meeting calendar for 7-8 December, resolving last edition's open question.[16] Mexico's Banxico holds its own decision Thursday 5 November — just outside this window — with both its current 6.50% rate and the Thursday date itself still only secondary-sourced; banxico.org.mx remained unreachable for a further edition.[17] December FOMC hike odds firmed again to approximately 77-80% (from approximately 74-75% last edition) per a fresh Polymarket Gamma-API pull and DeFi Rate's blended Kalshi/Polymarket aggregator; Kalshi's own direct fetch failed again (HTTP 429, a 21st straight failure) and CME FedWatch again timed out (a 17th straight failure).[18][19] No federal shutdown is in effect; H.R. 6500 funds agencies through 11 December 2026 — reconfirmed this edition via consistent secondary multi-outlet sourcing rather than a direct whitehouse.gov read, which returned inconclusive content this time.[20] Separately, a Federal Register filing (Doc 2025-21671) clarifies that Section 301 exclusions for 178 Chinese products lapse at 11:59pm ET on 9 November 2026, with the standard tariff rate resuming 10 November absent a further extension — resolving the prior one-day ambiguity between secondary sources, with no new extension filed as of this edition.[22]

4. Commodities and FX

Instrument	Level	Chg	Note
WTI crude	$88.12/bbl	-8.3%	Post-election fading war-risk premium plus a smaller-than-expected inventory draw[2][23]
Brent crude	$94.62/bbl	-8.67%	Same driver; down >14% for the week per CNBC[2]
Henry Hub nat. gas	$2.946/MMBtu	+1.76%	Front-month still NGZ6 (Dec); second straight largely-clean cross-source reconciliation (Yahoo $2.939)[23][24]
Gold (futures)	$4,075.20/oz	+3.42%	Kitco spot read smaller (+1.24% to $4,109.60) — prior edition's sign conflict did not recur; a magnitude gap persists[23][25]
Silver (futures)	$52.330/oz	+5.18%	Kitco spot +1.03% to $52.64 — same magnitude-gap pattern as gold[23][25]
Copper (LME cash)	$14,201.00/t	+0.64%	[26]

Copper (COMEX)	$6.4128/lb	+0.17%	Smaller gain than LME but same direction[23]
DXY	101.29-101.43	-0.30% to -0.58%	Yahoo and Investing.com now agree on direction, resolving a two-edition conflict this session; a magnitude gap remains[23][24]
EUR/USD	1.1229	+0.31%	
GBP/USD	1.3472	+0.42%	
USD/JPY	158.45	-0.14%	Yen firmer vs. dollar[23]
2-Yr Treasury	4.58%	-3bp	
10-Yr Treasury	4.90%	-5bp	
30-Yr Treasury	5.28%	-4bp	22nd straight clean reconciliation against Treasury's own par-yield page[27]

Crude's collapse was the clearest single commodity read-through from the election: WTI and Brent both fell more than 8% as traders priced out further Mideast escalation risk, compounding a smaller-than-expected inventory draw.[2] The dollar fell broadly — the two-edition DXY cross-source direction conflict (Yahoo Finance vs. an Investing.com futures-style proxy) resolved for this session, with both sources agreeing on a decline and all three major crosses confirming broad dollar softness; a residual magnitude gap remains.[23][24] Henry Hub posted a second consecutive largely clean two-source reconciliation after five straight problem editions, warranting a downgrade of this item's priority from "elevated" while still watching for one more confirming session.[23][24] Gold and silver both rose on futures and spot readings alike, resolving last edition's spot-vs-futures sign conflict, though a magnitude gap persisted (futures roughly triple Kitco's spot gain) — most plausibly a settlement-timing artifact, since gold's rally likely peaked around midday ahead of Kitco's evening quote, though this is not independently confirmed.[23][25]

5. Derivatives, volatility and positioning

The VIX posted its sharpest one-day decline logged in this report's history, falling 20.26% to 16.61 as the election outcome resolved a major source of uncertainty.[28] The move was concentrated at the front end: VIX9D cratered 30.83% to 15.19 and VVIX fell 15.82% to 90.41, while the mid-curve VIX3M (-11.61% to 18.80) and VIX6M (-7.31% to 20.68) fell by less. This fully resolved the term-structure kink that had persisted since Monday — VIX9D's premium over VIX and VIX3M flipped to a discount, restoring clean ascending contango across the whole curve (VIX9D 15.19 < VIX 16.61 < VIX3M 18.80 < VIX6M 20.68).[28] SKEW ticked up 0.59% to 150.90, a mild rise in tail-risk pricing even as at-the-money vol collapsed. All six series' timestamps were confirmed genuinely fresh (16:15-17:00 ET), and the feed's two known bugs (a duplicated prior-close field, a mis-divided percent-change) were absent for a third consecutive edition on manual recomputation.[28] Qualcomm's own pre-earnings options market priced an 11.82% implied move (20 November expiry, at-the-money straddle); a conflicting 19.26% figure from a second venue was investigated and rejected as unreliable.[29] Dealer-gamma estimates (zerogex.io, SpotGamma) remained unavailable for an 18th and 12th consecutive edition respectively. No new CFTC Commitment of Traders report fell inside the window, as expected — the next is due Friday 6 November, 3:30pm ET, covering Tuesday 3 November data; the CFTC's planned move to twice-weekly releases still has no confirmed start date.[21] Funding conditions showed no stress: SOFR 3.97%, EFFR and OBFR both 3.88% (a 9bp SOFR-EFFR spread, within normal range); ON RRP take-up was $225bn Wednesday versus $427bn Tuesday, with no primary-sourced award rate or IORB level obtained this edition (both secondary-corroborated only).[30][31]

6. The day ahead

Date	Event	Consensus / context
Thu 5 Nov, noon UK	Bank of England MPC decision	Bank Rate currently 3.75% (held 6-3 in Sept); date primary-confirmed last edition[32]
Thu 5 Nov	Banxico decision	Current rate approx. 6.50%; a speculative, unconfirmed analyst call floats a 25bp cut[17]
Fri 6 Nov, 8:30am ET	October US employment report	No consensus found this edition; September printed +29,000, unemployment 4.2%
Fri 6 Nov, 3:30pm ET	CFTC Commitment of Traders	Covers Tuesday 3 November positioning data[21]
Wed 11 Nov	Veterans Day	Equities open, full bond-market close per SIFMA's 2026 recommendation — same pattern as Columbus Day[33]
Mon 9 Nov, 11:59pm ET	Section 301 exclusion lapse (178 Chinese products)	Standard tariff rate resumes 10 Nov absent a further extension[22]
Sat 14 Nov	Q3 2026 13F filing deadline	Natural lead item for the Monday 16 Nov edition

Sector setup we take into Thursday's session

- Energy enters Thursday under pressure after oil's 8%+ crash; watch for any OPEC+ or Iran-diplomacy headlines that could reverse the move.
- Technology was the one sector that did not participate in Wednesday's rally (XLK flat); Qualcomm's miss and Amdocs' guidance cut add two fresh single-name headwinds heading into Thursday.
- Financials, Real Estate and Discretionary head into Thursday with the week's clearest rate-sensitive tailwind, following both the Treasury curve's 3-5bp decline and a divided, likely less fiscally expansive, Congress.
- The VIX's near-total unwind removes much of the hedging premium that built up Monday-Tuesday; watch whether Thursday's BoE decision or Friday's jobs report reintroduces any of it.

Annex A — Assumptions, corrections and status

- No correction box this edition — nothing published in a prior edition was found to be wrong.
- WTI's Tuesday 3 Nov change: edition 56 logged "+0.13%"; this edition's fresh pull of the same session instead implies -0.38% off a $96.09 level. An unresolved continuity discrepancy, disclosed rather than silently reconciled — Wednesday's own -8.3% change is sourced independently (CNBC) and does not depend on which Tuesday base is correct.
- Minor vendor-revision variances found on fresh re-fetches of Tuesday's base vs. what edition 56 logged: gold futures approx. 0.17%, silver futures approx. 0.34%, COMEX copper approx. 0.13%, Yahoo's DXY Tuesday print approx. 0.37% (moving toward, not away from, Investing.com's figure). All disclosed per the standing vendor-revision discipline; none changed any conclusion.
- Qualcomm's pre-report consensus EPS varied across sources (approx. $2.20, $2.23, $2.36); this edition used the $2.36 LSEG/Reuters figure as the primary comparison and flags the spread.
- Qualcomm's -7.52% after-hours print is a late-session snapshot (approx. 7:59pm ET), not a confirmed final settle — the best available figure, not treated as a close.
- US government shutdown/funding status was reconfirmed via consistent secondary multi-outlet sourcing this edition rather than a direct whitehouse.gov read, which returned inconclusive (binary/blank) content — a one-edition sourcing-tier downgrade from the usual direct confirmation.
- ON RRP award rate and IORB were not obtained from a primary source this edition — ON RRP volumes only (NY Fed Markets Data API); IORB corroborated only via a secondary aggregator (cbonds.pl).
- The Riksbank's own press release did not state a vote split for the 4 November decision; minutes due 10 November may clarify. The prior approx. 1.75% rate, previously only secondary-sourced, is now confirmed directly by the Riksbank's own release as the pre-hike level.
- A new instance of the forward-looking-calendar-aggregator trap: one aggregator listed Amdocs as reporting 10 November (actually 3-4 Nov, via Form 6-K, which some 8-K-only aggregator feeds miss) and another listed Kyndryl as reporting 6 November (actually 4 Nov). Both corrected before publication via direct SEC EDGAR checks.
- Caterpillar's earlier mis-dated "reports 4 Nov" planning assumption (corrected last edition, confirmed actual date 29 Oct) remained correctly excluded this edition — no CAT-specific move is reported.
- Final House and Senate seat tallies were still being finalized as of window close (Alaska and Mississippi Senate races and a number of House races uncalled per contemporaneous reporting); the "Democrats control both chambers" framing reflects the AP-called, multi-outlet-confirmed status as of Wednesday, not a fully final count.
- Gold/silver futures-vs-spot magnitude gap (futures roughly triple Kitco's spot gain) is disclosed as likely a settlement-timing artifact but is not independently confirmed as such.

Annex B — Data points sought but not verified this edition

- ISM Services PMI sub-index detail (prices paid, new orders, employment) for October 2026.
- Riksbank's 4 November vote split/dissent detail (minutes due 10 Nov).
- Banxico's 5 November decision outcome (falls outside this window).
- October 2026 US employment report consensus figure — not found despite multiple attempts; appears not yet published.
- An independent, non-AP-wire index-close report (e.g. a standalone Reuters wrap) — relied on AP-wire mirrors (La Nación, WTOP) plus ETF triangulation instead.
- Any analyst upgrade, downgrade or price-target action dated specifically to Wednesday 4 November 2026.
- CME Henry Hub settlement and Barchart NGZ26 — both failed to return usable data, as in prior editions.
- MarketWatch's DXY page — blocked by tooling for a second straight edition.
- Independent secondary-source confirmation of the VIX close print — same-day search coverage not yet indexed.
- Dealer gamma (zerogex.io, SpotGamma) — both unavailable, as in prior editions.
- Fed speaker appearances specifically dated 4 November 2026 — none found despite multiple searches.

Annex C — Sources

- [1] CNBC, "Crude oil prices fall below $90 a barrel as Vance blames GOP election defeat on Iran war," 4 Nov 2026
- [2] CNBC, as above (oil price figures and driver)
- [3] AP, "How major US stock indexes fared," 4 Nov 2026, via La Nación and WTOP wire syndication mirrors
- [4] Stockanalysis.com, SPY/DIA/QQQ/IWM price-history pages, close 4 Nov 2026
- [5] Stockanalysis.com, SPDR sector ETF price-history pages, close 4 Nov 2026
- [6] Qualcomm Inc., Form 8-K Exhibit 99.1 (FQ4/FY2026 results), SEC EDGAR, filed 4 Nov 2026
- [7] Stockanalysis.com, single-stock price-history pages (QCOM, UBER, DUOL, CRCT, KD, DOX, HELE), close/AH 4 Nov 2026
- [8] Uber Technologies Inc., Form 8-K (Q3 2026 results), SEC EDGAR, filed 4 Nov 2026
- [9] Duolingo Inc., Q3 2026 earnings release, SEC EDGAR
- [10] Cricut Inc., Form 8-K (Q3 2026 results), SEC EDGAR, filed 3 Nov 2026
- [11] Kyndryl Holdings Inc., Form 8-K Exhibit 99.1 (Q2 FY2027 results), SEC EDGAR, filed 4 Nov 2026
- [12] Amdocs Ltd., Form 6-K (Q4/FY2026 results and FY2027 guidance), SEC EDGAR, filed 4 Nov 2026
- [13] Helen of Troy Ltd., Form 8-K (Items 7.01/9.01), SEC EDGAR, filed 4 Nov 2026
- [14] Riksbank, press release "Policy rate raised to 2 per cent," riksbank.se, 4 Nov 2026
- [15] Investing.com, Economic Calendar, ISM Services PMI, October 2026 release
- [16] Reserve Bank of Australia, "2026 Monetary Policy Board Meeting Dates," rba.gov.au
- [17] TradingEconomics, Mexico interest-rate page (secondary sourcing)
- [18] Polymarket Gamma API (gamma-api.polymarket.com/public-search), December FOMC contract, snapshot 4-5 Nov 2026
- [19] DeFi Rate, blended Kalshi/Polymarket Fed-decision snapshot, defirate.com, 4 Nov 2026 7:54pm ET
- [20] Multiple outlets reconfirming H.R. 6500 funding through 11 Dec 2026 (secondary sourcing this edition)
- [21] CFTC, Press Release 9316-26 (27 Oct 2026) and cftc.gov release schedule
- [22] Federal Register Doc 2025-21671 / USTR notice, Section 301 exclusion extension
- [23] Investing.com, futures/FX historical-data pages (WTI, Brent, gold, silver, COMEX copper, DXY, EUR/USD, GBP/USD, USD/JPY), 4 Nov 2026
- [24] Yahoo Finance, NG=F and DX-Y.NYB historical data, 4 Nov 2026
- [25] Kitco, live gold/silver spot quotes, 4 Nov 2026 approx. 8:26pm ET
- [26] Westmetall.com, LME copper settlement, 4 Nov 2026
- [27] U.S. Department of the Treasury, Daily Treasury Par Yield Curve Rates (TextView), home.treasury.gov, 4 Nov 2026
- [28] CBOE, delayed-quotes API (cdn-api.cboe.com), VIX/VIX9D/VIX3M/VIX6M/VVIX/SKEW, 4 Nov 2026 close
- [29] Optionslam.com, Qualcomm implied-move (at-the-money straddle, 20 Nov 2026 expiry)
- [30] Federal Reserve Bank of New York, Markets Data API (markets.newyorkfed.org), SOFR/EFFR/OBFR/TGCR/BGCR and ON RRP operations, 3-4 Nov 2026
- [31] Cbonds.pl, IORB secondary corroboration
- [32] Daily Economic Briefing edition 56 (4 Nov 2026), itself confirmed directly against bankofengland.co.uk's "Upcoming MPC dates" page
- [33] SIFMA, 2026 U.S. holiday schedule and Veterans Day fixed-income market-close recommendation, sifma.org

Method: every figure traces to a named source in Annex C; where sources disagreed, the better-corroborated figure was used and the conflict disclosed. Nothing estimated or filled from memory — unverifiable items are listed in Annex B. Not investment advice.